

The mixed brush set actually contains a lot of brushes that I have gathered over the years. Although we will not be using all of them, since I am not aware of the authors' names, it's better to give credit to all those who have created these brushes. With that said and done, you are free to use these brushes—grab them from <http://rapidshare.com/files/399891232/brushes.7z.html>.

To install the brushes, just unzip the archive into `~/gimp/brushes`. Restart the GIMP, and notice that the new brushes are visible in the list of brushes. With the brushes installed, let us get started with the wallpaper.

Step 1 Open the GIMP and start a new presentation with your desired resolution. For this wallpaper, I am using a massive 2560 x 1600 resolution.

Step 2 With the FG colour set to #5b0005 and BG set to #ba570f, provide a vertical gradient, as shown in Figure 1.

Step 3 Create a new transparent layer and set the FG colour to #b05fc1. Change the gradient mode to *Transparent* and apply a gradient from bottom to top as shown in Part 2 of Figure 1.

From here onwards, we will be relying on the vector brushes. Almost all the brushes have identical names, so look at the brushes' screenshot for precise details. I will try to post the screenshot of all the brushes used, to make things clear, but not all can be included, so go through the whole selection of brushes at least once.

 **Note:** To select a brush, either search through the behemoth collection, or simply enter the full name under the *Brush name* dialogue box.

Step 4 Create a new layer and name it 'Sun Ray'; set the FG colour to white. With the 'Risingsun Brushes by Blazter [JavierZhX].abr-017' brush selected, set the scale to 2.7 and apply the brush with its focus at the centre. Set the layer to Overlay.

Step 5 Create a new layer and name it 'Character' and set the FG colour to black. With the "Jumping_People_Brush_Set_by_eMelody.abr-001" brush selected, set the scale to 4.30. Apply the brush at the middle of the wallpaper so that it covers the focus point of the Sun Ray effect.

Step 6 In a new layer named 'Grass and Flies', grab the brush "Vectorpack_VOL2_brushes_set_by_solenero73.abr-011" (for grass) and apply it in the lower part of the wallpaper, with white as the FG. Set the scale to 2.0.

For the butterfly part, there are a couple of butterfly brushes available in the set. Use any of them and apply them 2-3 times near the character, as shown in the wallpaper. Scale it accordingly.

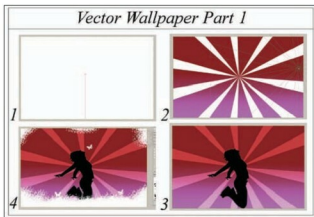


Figure 1: Vector Wallpaper Part 1



Figure 2: Vector Wallpaper Part 2

One thing that you may have noticed is that the grass brush has artificial ends that don't look like grass, in the right portion of the brush. In order to overcome the issue, make sure the left part covers the screen, while reapplying the brush. Even though we do our best to overcome the artificial look, there are still some traces at the corners of the wallpaper. To make it more precise, we can use a bubble brush, which not only overcomes the artificial look, but adds a very pleasant appearance to the centre of the wallpaper.

Step 7 To perform the above-mentioned task on the wallpaper, create a new layer and name it 'Bubbles'. Grab the "387_ABSTRACT_VECTOR_BRUSHES.abr-237" brush and gently apply it at the four corners of the wallpaper. Apply it at the top centre position as well (we will get to that part later).

Step 8 Since the character selected is jumping in the air, it will be good if we add some airy sort of brush strokes alongside it. To do this, create a new layer and name it 'Strobe'. Select the "387_ABSTRACT_VECTOR_BRUSHES.abr-228" with the scale set to it. Apply the brush from where the grass ends near the legs of the character. Holding the left mouse button, continue dragging the mouse above, and try to form a curve/bow shape using the same settings. Once done, repeat on the opposite side as well.